# Prepositions of Location

Prepositions of location tell us **where** something is.

**à — at / in / to**

Used for a general location or destination.

- Je suis **à** la maison. *(I am at home.)*
- Il va **à** l'école. *(He is going to school.)*
- Elle est **à** la piscine. *(She is at the swimming pool.)*
- Nous allons **à** Paris. *(We are going to Paris.)*

**dans — in / inside**

Used when something is inside something else.

- Le chat est **dans** la boîte. *(The cat is in the box.)*
- Les clés sont **dans** le tiroir. *(The keys are in the drawer.)*
- Il y a du lait **dans** le frigo. *(There is milk in the fridge.)*
- Les enfants jouent **dans** le jardin. *(The children are playing in the garden.)*

**sur — on / on top of**

Used when something is on something else.

- Le livre est **sur** la table. *(The book is on the table.)*
- Il y a un chat **sur** le toit. *(There is a cat on the roof.)*

- Les lunettes sont **sur** mon nez. *(The glasses are on my nose.)*
- Le chapeau est **sur** la chaise. *(The hat is on the chair.)*

**sous — under / below**

Used for something underneath another thing.

- Les chaussures sont **sous** le lit. *(The shoes are under the bed.)*
- Le chat dort **sous** la table. *(The cat is sleeping under the table.)*
- Il y a un tapis **sous** la moquette. *(There is a rug under the carpet.)*
- Le livre est **sous** la pile de magazines. *(The book is under the stack of magazines.)*

**entre — between**

Used when something is between two things.

- La maison est **entre** l'école et le parc. *(The house is between the school and the park.)*
- Le chat est assis **entre** les deux chiens. *(The cat is sitting between the two dogs.)*
- Il y a une table **entre** les deux chaises. *(There is a table between the two chairs.)*
- Le restaurant est **entre** le cinéma et la bibliothèque. *(The restaurant is between the cinema and the library.)*

**devant — in front of**

Used when something is located before or facing something else.

- La voiture est **devant** la maison. *(The car is in front of the house.)*
- Les enfants jouent **devant** l'école. *(The children are playing in front of the school.)*
- Il y a un banc **devant** le parc. *(There is a bench in front of the park.)*
- Le chat est assis **devant** la fenêtre. *(The cat is sitting in front of the window.)*

**derrière — behind**

Used when something is at the back of something else.

- Le jardin est **derrière** la maison. *(The garden is behind the house.)*
- Les arbres sont **derrière** l'église. *(The trees are behind the church.)*
- Il y a une rue **derrière** le magasin. *(There is a street behind the store.)*
- Le chat se cache **derrière** le canapé. *(The cat is hiding behind the sofa.)*

**à côté de — next to / beside**

Used when something is right next to something else.

- Le parc est **à côté de** la bibliothèque. *(The park is next to the library.)*
- La maison est **à côté de** l'école. *(The house is beside the school.)*
- Il y a une église **à côté du** restaurant. *(There is a church next to the restaurant.)*
- Le chat dort **à côté de** son maître. *(The cat sleeps next to its owner.)*

**près de — near / close to**

Used when something is nearby or close.

- Le supermarché est **près de** la maison. *(The supermarket is near the house.)*
- Il y a un parc **près du** centre-ville. *(There is a park close to downtown.)*
- Le bureau est **près de** la fenêtre. *(The desk is near the window.)*
- La station de métro est **près de** l'hôtel. *(The metro station is close to the hotel.)*

**au-dessus de — above / over**

Used when something is higher than another object.

- L'oiseau vole **au-dessus de** la maison. *(The bird is flying above the house.)*
- Il y a des nuages **au-dessus des** montagnes. *(There are clouds over the mountains.)*
- Le tableau est accroché **au-dessus du** canapé. *(The painting is hung above the sofa.)*
- Les étoiles brillent **au-dessus de** la ville. *(The stars shine over the city.)*

**en bas de — at the bottom of / downstairs**

Used when something is at a lower level.

- Les clés sont **en bas de** l'escalier. *(The keys are at the bottom of the stairs.)*
- Il y a un parc **en bas de** la colline. *(There is a park at the bottom of the hill.)*
- Le chat dort **en bas de** son lit. *(The cat sleeps at the bottom of its bed.)*
- La salle de bain est **en bas de** l'escalier. *(The bathroom is downstairs.)*

**au milieu de — in the middle of**

Used when something is at the center of something.

- Il y a une île **au milieu de** la rivière. *(There is an island in the middle of the river.)*
- Le parc se trouve **au milieu du** quartier. *(The park is located in the middle of the neighborhood.)*
- La table est placée **au milieu de** la pièce. *(The table is placed in the middle of the room.)*
- Les enfants jouent **au milieu du** jardin. *(The children are playing in the middle of the garden.)*

**à l’intérieur de — inside of**

Used when something is within an enclosed space.

- Il y a une surprise **à l'intérieur de** la boîte. *(There is a surprise inside the box.)*
- Le chat se cache **à l'intérieur du** placard. *(The cat is hiding inside the closet.)*
- Les enfants jouent **à l'intérieur de** la maison. *(The children are playing inside the house.)*

- La voiture est **à l’intérieur du** garage. *(The car is inside the garage)*

**à l’extérieur de — outside of**

Used when something is on the outer side or beyond.

- Il y a une voiture **à l'extérieur de** la maison. *(There is a car outside the house.)*
- Les enfants jouent **à l'extérieur de** l'école. *(The children are playing outside the school.)*
- Il y a un jardin **à l'extérieur du** bâtiment. *(There is a garden outside the building.)*
- Le chien dort **à l'extérieur de** la maison. *(The dog sleeps outside the house.)*

**autour de — around**

Used when something surrounds or circles something else.

- Il y a des arbres **autour de** la maison. *(There are trees around the house.)*
- Les enfants courent **autour de** la cour de récréation. *(The children are running around the playground.)*
- Il y a une clôture **autour du** jardin. *(There is a fence around the garden.)*
- Les montagnes sont **autour de** la vallée. *(The mountains surround the valley.)*

**vers — toward**

Used to show direction or movement to something.

- Le train va **vers** la gare. *(The train is going towards the train station.)*
- Les oiseaux volent **vers** le sud. *(The birds fly towards the south.)*
- Je marche **vers** la maison. *(I walk towards the house.)*
- Il se dirige **vers** la plage. *(He is heading towards the beach.)*

